

Employee Policies & Procedures

Quick Reference for Frontline Healthcare Staff

This guide summarizes the policies that most directly affect your day-to-day work supporting the individuals we serve. It is a plain-language overview — not the complete policy manual. Where this summary and the full Policies & Procedures differ, the full manual and applicable Ohio DODD rules and state and federal law govern. Keep this handy and ask your supervisor or Human Resources if anything is unclear.

1. Confidentiality & HIPAA

We protect the utmost privacy of every client's personal and health information, consistent with HIPAA and Ohio law.

- **Minimum necessary** — access and use only the information you need to do your job.
- **Keep it secure** — keep paperwork out of sight; lock screens and protect passwords; never leave records visible.
- **Written release required** — share client information only with those directly involved in care, and only with a written release of information.
- **Off the record** — never discuss clients outside work or on social media.
- **It continues** — your duty of confidentiality remains even after you stop working here. Improper disclosure can lead to termination and legal penalties.

2. The Rights of the People We Serve

Every individual we support has rights we must protect at all times, including the right to:

- Be treated with courtesy, respect, dignity, and individuality.
- A safe, sanitary living environment with privacy and independence.
- Make decisions that affect their own lives and manage their finances based on their ability.
- Be free from abuse and from unnecessary chemical or physical restraints.
- Voice grievances and recommend changes without restraint, coercion, discrimination, or reprisal.
- Confidential treatment of their personal and medical records.

Violating any individual's rights leads to immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

3. Self-Determination & Person-Centered Support

We support people to plan their own lives and pursue what matters to them. Services are built around each person through person-centered planning and their Individual Service Plan (ISP) — not around staff convenience. Offer real choices, respect a person's right to say no, and help them build skills toward independence.

4. Service Delivery & the ISP

- Review each individual's ISP before and during the delivery of services.
- Complete all required person-centered and role-specific training before working with an individual.
- Deliver services in accordance with the ISP and in a person-centered manner.

5. Documentation

Accurate, timely documentation is essential. Monitor the individuals you support and record their daily progress on the tracking log every shift. If your supervisor flags a documentation issue, resolve it by the end of that day. Falsifying or failing to document accurately is a misconduct subject to corrective action up to termination.

6. Medication Administration & Health-Related Activities

- Only staff who are appropriately certified may administer medication or perform health-related activities.
- Follow the Medication Administration Record (MAR) exactly; document accurately and on time.
- Give medications within the allowed time window — outside it is an error.
- Store medications securely; never give a contaminated or discontinued medication.
- Report any medication error immediately; serious errors are reported as a UI or MUI.
- Controlled substances are monitored and kept secure with required counts and documentation.

7. Universal Precautions & Infection Control

Observe universal/standard precautions at all times — hand hygiene, proper use of PPE, and safe handling practices — to protect the individuals we serve, your coworkers, and yourself.

8. Emergencies & Incident Reporting (MUI / UI)

A Major Unusual Incident (MUI) is any alleged, suspected, or actual event that adversely affects an individual's health and safety; an Unusual Incident (UI) is off-routine but not a major risk. Incidents are reported under DODD rule 5123:2-17-02.

- **Life-threatening emergency** — call 911, give first aid/CPR if trained, then notify the on-call supervisor, guardian/custodial agency, and family.
- **Document promptly** — a life-threatening incident requires an MUI within 24 hours; record times, circumstances, and what you did.
- **Know the postings** — emergency numbers and evacuation routes are posted at each location.
- **When unsure** — report it and ask your supervisor whether it is a UI or MUI.

9. Recognizing & Reporting Abuse — and the Abuser Registry

You are a mandated reporter. Report immediately if you suspect any of the following against an individual:

- Neglect
- Physical abuse
- Sexual abuse
- Verbal abuse
- Exploitation / misappropriation

Failing to report suspected abuse, neglect, or misappropriation can place you on the DODD Abuser Registry and is itself a serious offense. You must also report in writing within 14 days if you are ever charged with, convicted of, or plead guilty to a disqualifying offense.

10. Background Checks & Convictions

All staff authorize criminal background checks (Ohio BCI and others) and are enrolled in the Rapback fingerprint database. Certain convictions may disqualify employment. If you are convicted of any criminal activity while employed, notify Human Resources in writing within the required timeframe.

11. Training Requirements

- Complete orientation training before beginning work at any site.
- Complete all relevant trainings within 15 days after orientation.
- Maintain current certifications (including CPR/First Aid where required) by attending all scheduled trainings.
- If a client's ISP changes, complete any new required training as soon as possible.

Failing to keep training and certifications current can lead to corrective action up to termination.

12. Attendance, Timekeeping & Scheduling

- Work your scheduled hours; you may be assigned to other sites based on staffing needs.
- Arrive at least 5 minutes before your shift; 3+ minutes late is tardy.
- Record arrival and departure accurately — never falsify times.
- Call off at least 12 hours before your shift; a no-notice, full-day absence may be treated as a voluntary resignation.
- Switch shifts only with a signed, supervisor-approved alternative-shift agreement.

13. Conduct, Conflicts of Interest & Client Funds

- Treat every individual, family member, and coworker with dignity and respect.
- Do not borrow money from, or sell to / buy from, an individual without prior written team approval.
- Do not provide paid services to your own spouse or minor child.
- Safeguard any client funds you handle, keep them separate from agency and personal funds, and account for them accurately.
- Follow the dress code and phone/electronic-device rules; never use a consumer's phone without authorization.

14. Drug-Free Workplace

Frontline has a zero-tolerance policy for controlled substances and alcohol abuse. Random and for-cause testing (reasonable suspicion and post-accident) applies. Refusing a test, tampering with a sample, or testing positive for illegal drugs results in termination. Never report to or remain on duty under the influence.

15. Progressive Discipline

Discipline is progressive and aimed at correcting behavior: (1) verbal warning, (2) written warning, (3) final warning, (4) termination. Retraining may be used for minor issues; depending on severity, a step may be skipped or an offense may result in immediate dismissal.

16. Raising Concerns & Grievances

Clients and employees may file a grievance at any time, and it is against our principles and the law to retaliate against anyone who raises a concern in good faith. Most issues are resolved fastest by talking with your supervisor. For sensitive or unresolved matters, contact the Client Rights Officer (CRO) or Human Resources.

17. Who to Contact

- **Day-to-day questions & scheduling** — your immediate supervisor.
- **Urgent / after-hours** — the Director of Operations (on call 24 hours a day, 7 days a week).
- **Rights, grievances & complaints** — the Client Rights Officer (CRO).
- **Pay, benefits & HR** — Human Resources / Payroll.
- **Emergencies** — call 911, then the on-call supervisor.